irritation from the tape that had fastened the tube in my nose at the hospital. When Nancy's dermatologist saw it, he clipped off a little piece, and a biopsy showed that it was a low-level carcinoma—not something to be ignored, but by no means life-threatening.

Once again, however, some of the papers reported that I had cancer. Such carcinomas, the doctors said, are fairly common, a result of spending too much time under the sun. Nancy had had one removed from her upper lip the year before. For me, it was a result of a lifetime spent outdoors. From the day I started those summers working as a lifeguard, I'd enjoyed being outside and getting a tan; I tanned easily and seldom got sunburned. When I got into pictures, I *had* to stay tanned. I couldn't wear makeup, so I was always the first one out under the sun working on a tan. Now, the doctors told me, either I had to stay out of the sun or button up and wear a hat when I did go out. That night I wrote in my diary: "First I have to give up popcorn and now sunbathing." During my colon operation, the surgeons found evidence of diverticulitis, an inflammation of the intestine that can be easily irritated by small particles of food, and they said: No more peanuts and popcorn. I'd been a popcorn fiend since childhood; if I'd had to, I could have lived on popcorn. I often went into the kitchen and cooked it myself. I didn't think I could ever give it up, but now I did.

Three weeks after I left the hospital, the doctors gave their okay for Nancy and me to finish my recuperation at the ranch.

It was more beautiful than ever at Rancho del Cielo, and for almost three weeks we had picture-perfect weather—*too perfect* for certain kinds of pictures: These were days when we might have enjoyed a little fog.

We had always loved our privacy on this piece of ground, but this time out, on our first evening, we turned on a television set and saw ourselves. The networks had found a